

A FRAMEWORK IN CHAPTERS

Chapter Nine

Invasion

*Foreign power, local extraction:
six contemporary instances*

Invasion is the system by which a foreign power invades a locale to extract something tangible and enforce its standards on the locals. This chapter runs it through the five domains — covering the six contemporary instances: IMF/World Bank neoliberalism, dollar hegemony, Saudi/Wahhabist religious invasion, American evangelical Christianity, Silicon Valley tech invasion, and Chinese economic invasion.

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CHAPTER 9 OF AN ONGOING FRAMEWORK

Invasion

Invasion is the eighth Fundamental Matrix. The framework’s outline names six contemporary instances: neoliberalism (IMF/World Bank), dollar hegemony, Saudi/Wahhabist religious invasion, American evangelical Christianity, Silicon Valley tech invasion, and Chinese economic invasion. All share the common logic of ‘foreigner invades a locale to extract something tangible and enforce their standards on the locals.’

Invasion is distinguished from Settler Colonialism (Chapter 10, which is invasion to extract existence from locals and enforce foreign existence at the expense of locals) and from Coloniality (Chapter 11, which is the residue of concluded invasions). Invasion is the active, ongoing extraction-and-enforcement by a foreign power that is still foreign — not yet settled, not yet concluded.

A note on method. The Interpersonal, Disciplinary, and Structural sections take the naive approach — each triad described as if happening for the first time, with no networks, residues, or Canon referenced. The Hegemonic Domain section is where Canon and Practice finally enter the picture.

READING NOTE

Same convention as Chapters 1 through 8. Every paragraph is written to be tweetable. Where you see literal blanks (____), the framework is asking you to write yourself into it. The blanks are the difference between reading about Invasion and locating yourself inside it.

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SECTION 1

1. Definition: What Invasion Extracts, Enforces, and Removes

Invasion is the system by which a foreign power invades a locale to extract something tangible and enforce its standards on the locals. The theoretical foundations draw on Edward Said's *Orientalism* (1978), which showed how the Western construction of the 'Orient' was the cultural infrastructure of imperial invasion. Said's *Culture and Imperialism* (1993) extended the analysis to the cultural canon.

Frantz Fanon's *The Wretched of the Earth* (1961) and Kwame Nkrumah's *Neo-Colonialism: The Last Stage of Imperialism* (1965) supplied the political vocabulary: colonialism had ended formally but had been replaced by neo-colonialism, in which the foreign power extracts through economic, cultural, and political means rather than through direct administration. Walter Rodney's *How Europe Underdeveloped Africa* (1972) documented the historical process by which European invasion underdeveloped the African continent.

Samir Amin's *Maldevelopment* (1990) and Immanuel Wallerstein's world-systems analysis (*The Modern World-System*, 1974 onward) showed how the core-periphery structure of the global economy channels resources from the periphery to the core. Anibal Quijano's 'coloniality of power' (2000) argued that colonial relations of power persisted after formal decolonisation. Achille Mbembe's *Critique of Black Reason* (2017) extended the analysis to the racialised logic of extraction.

For the contemporary period, David Harvey's *The New Imperialism* (2003) and *A Brief History of Neoliberalism* (2005) trace the post-1980 wave of invasion under neoliberal ideology. Naomi Klein's *The Shock Doctrine* (2007) documents the deliberate use of crisis — natural disaster, war, economic collapse — to impose foreign economic standards on weakened states. Vijay Prashad's *The Poorer Nations* (2012) traces the post-colonial Global South's subordination to the IMF/World Bank regime.

1.1 What Invasion Extracts

Invasion extracts six things. First, **natural resources**: the oil that has been extracted from the Niger Delta by Shell, Chevron, ExxonMobil, and other foreign majors since the 1950s, with the vast majority of profit leaving the country. The solid minerals extracted by Chinese and Western companies across the North. The timber extracted by foreign logging companies across the South.

Second, **labour at subsistence wages**: the worker in the foreign-owned factory, the worker on the foreign-owned construction site, the worker on the foreign-owned plantation. The worker is paid a fraction of the value of what they produce. The surplus is repatriated. Third, **capital flight**: the profit that leaves the country as dividends, interest, management fees, and transfer pricing. The Nigerian economy loses an estimated \$15-18 billion a year to illicit financial flows, much of it through foreign multinational corporations.

Fourth, **market access**: the foreign corporation's access to the Nigerian consumer. The telecoms companies (MTN, Airtel) extract billions in profit from Nigerian subscribers. The fast-moving consumer goods companies (Unilever, Nestlé, P&G;) extract profit from Nigerian households. The financial services companies (Standard Chartered, Citi) extract profit from Nigerian transactions.

Fifth, **data and attention**: the Silicon Valley platforms (Google, Meta, Twitter/X, TikTok) extract Nigerian users' data and attention, monetising both through advertising. The Nigerian user produces the data; the platform sells it. Sixth, **regulatory concessions**: the foreign corporation's extraction of favourable regulation through lobbying, through investment treaties, through structural adjustment conditions. Each of these is tangible and consequential.

1.2 What Invasion Enforces

Invasion enforces five standards. First, the **foreign standard of economic management**: the IMF's structural adjustment programmes, the World Bank's poverty reduction strategy papers, the foreign consultant's prescription. The Nigerian economic policymaker is taught that there is an 'international best practice' to which Nigerian policy must conform.

Second, the **foreign standard of religion**: the Saudi-funded Wahhabist Islam that has displaced the more tolerant Sufi Islam in parts of the North since the 1970s; the American evangelical Christianity that has reshaped southern Nigerian Christianity since the 1970s. The Nigerian religious practitioner is taught that the foreign version of their religion is the true version.

Third, the **foreign standard of technology**: the Silicon Valley platform economy that has become the default infrastructure for Nigerian commerce, communication, and culture. The Chinese-built infrastructure (railways, airports, ports) that has become the default for Nigerian transport. The Nigerian is taught that foreign technology is modern and indigenous technology is backward.

Fourth, the **foreign standard of culture and language**: English as the language of education, business, and government; Western dress as professional; Western food as modern. The Nigerian is taught that English is the language of sophistication and indigenous languages are the languages of the village. Fifth, the **foreign standard of law**: the English common law that governs Nigerian commercial disputes; the international arbitration that governs Nigerian contracts with foreign corporations. Each standard is enforced by institutions, by the market, and by the triads below.

1.3 What Options Invasion Removes

Concretely, Invasion removes the option of sovereign economic policy. The Nigerian government cannot pursue industrial policy, capital controls, or currency management without risking IMF/World Bank disapproval, credit-rating downgrades, and capital flight. The Structural Adjustment Programme of 1986 was imposed under military rule without public consent and reshaped Nigerian economic policy for four decades.

It removes the option of indigenous religious practice. The traditional Yoruba, Igbo, and Hausa religious practitioners are marginalised by both the foreign-imported Pentecostal Christianity and the

foreign-imported Wahhabist Islam. The Nigerian who would rather practice the religion of their ancestors is treated as backward by both foreign-imported faiths. It removes the option of indigenous technology. The local software developer cannot compete with Silicon Valley platforms that have captured the Nigerian market.

It removes the option of indigenous culture and language. The Nigerian child whose parents do not speak English at home is at a disadvantage in the English-medium school system. The Nigerian writer who writes in Yoruba, Igbo, or Hausa has a fraction of the audience of the Nigerian writer who writes in English. It removes the option of indigenous law. The Nigerian who would rather have their commercial dispute governed by customary law is forced into the English common law system.

It removes the option of refusing foreign investment. The Nigerian community that would rather not have a foreign mine on their land is overruled by the federal government, which has signed the concession. It removes the option of refusing foreign aid. The Nigerian government that would rather not accept USAID conditions is constrained by the need for the aid. It removes the option of refusing foreign debt. The Nigerian government that would rather not borrow from China is constrained by the need for infrastructure. Each removal is enforced by the foreign power, by the Nigerian state acting on the foreign power's behalf, and by the triads below.

SECTION 2 · NAIVE APPROACH

2. The Interpersonal Domain

The Interpersonal Domain contains five enforcement triads and five extraction triads. Each is described here as if happening for the first time — no networks, no residues, no Canon. Just the act, the conforming subject, the complicit witness, and (for extraction triads) the Non-Extracting Beneficiary. Each triad is illustrated across the six contemporary instances.

3.1 Enforcement Triad: Foreign Standard of Economic Management

The enforcer is the foreign economic institution that demands Nigerian economic policy conform to its standards. The IMF country representative who demands fuel subsidy removal. The World Bank country director who demands utility privatisation. The foreign consultant who prescribes deregulation. The foreign rating agency that downgrades Nigerian debt. The enforcement is performed by direct demand, by attaching conditions to loans, by credit-rating downgrades, or by withholding finance.

The subject conforms by adopting the prescribed policy. The Nigerian Finance Minister signs the SAP letter. The CBN Governor announces the devaluation. The Ministry of Power signs the privatisation agreement. The conforming act is the policy itself — the Nigerian government becomes the agent of foreign economic management.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Nigerian government loses the option to subsidise fuel for the poor, which is to say, loses the option to a basic welfare function. The Nigerian government loses the option to control the naira, which is to say, loses the option to monetary sovereignty. The Nigerian government loses the option to protect domestic industry, which is to say, loses the option to industrial policy.

The witness is the Nigerian policymaker or commentator who watches the foreign demand and says nothing, or who themselves invoke ‘international best practice’ and so model compliance. The witness’s complicity normalises the demand. The Nigerian economist who says ‘the IMF is right’ is closing the loop.

3.2 Enforcement Triad: Foreign Standard of Religion

The enforcer is the foreign religious institution that demands Nigerian religious practice conform to its standards. The Saudi-funded Islamic organisation that demands Wahhabist theology. The American megachurch that plants a Nigerian branch with American theology. The American televangelist whose broadcasts set the standard for Nigerian Pentecostalism. The enforcement is performed by funding, by training, by broadcasting, or by withholding recognition.

The subject conforms by adopting the foreign theology. The Nigerian Imam who returns from Saudi training preaches the Wahhabist line. The Nigerian pastor who attends the American conference imports the prosperity gospel. The Nigerian congregation that watches the American televangelist adopts his style. The conforming act is the religious performance itself — the Nigerian religious practitioner becomes the agent of foreign theology.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Nigerian Muslim loses the option to the more tolerant Sufi Islam of their grandparents, which is to say, loses the option to a less violent religious community. The Nigerian Christian loses the option to the more communal mainline Christianity of their grandparents, which is to say, loses the option to a less individualistic faith. The traditional religious practitioner loses the option to their indigenous religion, which is to say, loses the option to ancestral belonging.

The witness is the Nigerian religious practitioner who watches the foreign theology displace the indigenous and says nothing, or who themselves adopt the foreign and so model compliance. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the foreign religious institution's local leadership, who consume the funding and the status without personally commanding the theological displacement.

3.3 Enforcement Triad: Foreign Standard of Technology

The enforcer is the foreign technology institution that demands Nigerian technology conform to its standards. The Silicon Valley platform that sets the rules for Nigerian users. The Chinese construction company that sets the standards for Nigerian infrastructure. The foreign software vendor whose proprietary format becomes the Nigerian default. The enforcement is performed by the platform's terms of service, by the construction company's contract, by the software's incompatibility with alternatives, or by the market dominance that makes refusal impossible.

The subject conforms by using the foreign technology. The Nigerian user signs up for WhatsApp. The Nigerian commuter rides the Chinese-built railway. The Nigerian office uses Microsoft. The conforming act is the use itself — the Nigerian becomes the user of foreign technology, generating data and profit for the foreign provider.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Nigerian user loses the option to communicate on a platform that does not extract their data, which is to say, loses the option to digital privacy. The Nigerian commuter loses the option to a railway built by Nigerian contractors, which is to say, loses the option to domestic industrial development. The Nigerian office loses the option to open-source alternatives, which is to say, loses the option to software sovereignty.

The witness is the Nigerian who watches the foreign technology displace the indigenous and says nothing, or who themselves use the foreign and so model compliance. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the Nigerian distributor of the foreign technology, who profits from the displacement without personally commanding it.

3.4 Enforcement Triad: Foreign Standard of Culture and Language

The enforcer is the foreign cultural institution that demands Nigerian culture and language conform to its standards. The English-medium school that requires English at all times. The multinational employer that requires Western dress. The foreign-funded film festival that requires Western narrative form. The streaming platform that requires Western production standards. The enforcement is performed by the school's policy, by the employer's dress code, by the festival's selection criteria, or by the platform's algorithm.

The subject conforms by performing the foreign culture. The Nigerian child speaks English at school. The Nigerian professional wears the Western suit. The Nigerian filmmaker adopts the Western narrative form. The conforming act is the performance itself — the Nigerian becomes the agent of foreign culture.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Nigerian child loses the option to develop in their indigenous language, which is to say, loses the option to cognitive development in the mother tongue that UNESCO has shown is superior. The Nigerian professional loses the option to dress comfortably, which is to say, loses the option to a body not constrained by Western norms. The Nigerian filmmaker loses the option to indigenous narrative form, which is to say, loses the option to a culture that is not Western-shaped.

The witness is the Nigerian who watches the foreign culture displace the indigenous and says nothing, or who themselves perform the foreign and so model compliance. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the Nigerian who consumes the foreign culture as status signal — the parent whose child speaks English at home — without personally commanding the displacement.

3.5 Enforcement Triad: Foreign Standard of Law and Dress

The enforcer is the foreign legal or sartorial institution that demands Nigerian law and dress conform to its standards. The international arbitration tribunal that requires English commercial law. The multinational employer that requires Western dress. The foreign investor that requires 'investor-friendly' legal protection. The enforcement is performed by the contract, by the investment treaty, by the dress code, or by the withholding of investment.

The subject conforms by submitting to the foreign law and dress. The Nigerian business signs the contract with the international arbitration clause. The Nigerian employee wears the Western suit. The Nigerian government signs the investment treaty. The conforming act is the submission itself — the Nigerian becomes the subject of foreign law and dress.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Nigerian business loses the option to have disputes governed by Nigerian law, which is to say, loses the option to legal sovereignty. The Nigerian employee loses the option to dress in indigenous clothing, which is to say, loses the option to bodily comfort and cultural expression. The Nigerian government loses the option to regulate foreign investment in the national interest, which is to say, loses the option to regulatory sovereignty.

The witness is the Nigerian who watches the foreign law and dress displace the indigenous and says nothing, or who themselves submit to the foreign and so model compliance. The witness's complicity

is the shared acceptance that foreign law and dress are the standard.

3.6 Extraction Triad: Natural Resources

The extractor is the foreign corporation that extracts Nigerian natural resources. The foreign oil major (Shell, Chevron, ExxonMobil, Total, Eni) extracting Niger Delta oil. The foreign mining company extracting solid minerals. The foreign logging company extracting timber. The foreign agribusiness extracting cash crops. The extraction is performed by the concession, the joint venture, the production-sharing contract, or the licence.

The subject conforms by allowing the extraction. The Nigerian government grants the concession. The Nigerian community loses the land. The Nigerian worker is employed at subsistence wage. What is extracted is tangible: oil, minerals, timber, crops. The extraction transfers resources from Nigeria to the foreign corporation, with the vast majority of profit leaving the country.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Niger Delta community loses the option to fish in unpolluted waters, which is to say, loses the option to livelihood. The mining community loses the option to farm on unpolluted land. The logging community loses the option to forest products. The host community loses the option to a future not shaped by extraction.

The witness is the Nigerian who knows of the extraction and does not intervene, or who themselves benefit from employment with the extractor. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the Nigerian political elite who receive rents from the extraction without personally commanding it. The NNPC joint venture structure formalises this beneficiary role.

3.7 Extraction Triad: Labour at Subsistence Wages

The extractor is the foreign corporation that employs Nigerian labour at subsistence wages. The foreign-owned factory. The foreign-owned construction site. The foreign-owned plantation. The foreign-owned service company. The extraction is performed by the wage relation itself — the Nigerian worker is paid a fraction of the value of what they produce.

The subject conforms by working. What is extracted is the surplus value — the difference between what the worker produces and what the worker is paid. The extraction is invisible to the worker because the wage appears as fair exchange. The worker does not see the surplus because the surplus is repatriated as profit after the worker has gone home.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The factory worker who produces goods for export loses the option to consume what they produce, which is to say, loses the option to a life commensurate with their productivity. The construction worker on the Chinese-built site loses the option to safety standards that Chinese workers in China enjoy. The plantation worker loses the option to land of their own.

The witness is the Nigerian who watches the labour extraction and does not intervene, or who themselves employ Nigerian workers. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the Nigerian consumer who

buys the product at a price that reflects the foreign corporation's profit margin but does not personally command the wage extraction.

3.8 Extraction Triad: Capital Flight

The extractor is the foreign corporation that repatriates profit from Nigeria. The foreign oil major that declares dividends to foreign shareholders. The foreign bank that charges management fees to the Nigerian subsidiary. The foreign trading company that uses transfer pricing to shift profit to low-tax jurisdictions. The extraction is performed by the dividend, the management fee, the transfer price, or the royalty.

The subject conforms by allowing the repatriation. The Nigerian government grants the repatriation permission. The Nigerian subsidiary pays the management fee. The Nigerian counterparty accepts the transfer price. What is extracted is tangible: money. The extraction transfers resources from Nigeria to the foreign jurisdiction, depleting the Nigerian economy.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Nigerian government loses the option to tax the profit at Nigerian rates, which is to say, loses the option to fiscal revenue. The Nigerian economy loses the option to the productive investment of the repatriated profit. The Nigerian currency loses the option to the foreign exchange that the repatriation consumes. The Nigerian economy loses an estimated \$15-18 billion a year to illicit financial flows.

The witness is the Nigerian who knows of the capital flight and does not intervene, or who themselves benefit from the foreign corporate structure. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the Nigerian shareholder in the foreign corporation, who receives a fraction of the repatriated profit without personally commanding the extraction.

3.9 Extraction Triad: Market Access

The extractor is the foreign corporation that accesses the Nigerian consumer. The telecoms company (MTN, Airtel) extracting billions in profit from Nigerian subscribers. The fast-moving consumer goods company (Unilever, Nestlé, P&G;) extracting profit from Nigerian households. The financial services company (Standard Chartered, Citi) extracting profit from Nigerian transactions. The extraction is performed by the subscription, the sale, the transaction fee, or the interest spread.

The subject conforms by consuming. What is extracted is the consumer surplus — the difference between what the Nigerian consumer pays and what the consumer would pay in a competitive market. The extraction is invisible to the consumer because the price appears as fair. The consumer does not see the profit repatriation.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Nigerian subscriber loses the option to a telecoms market not dominated by foreign companies, which is to say, loses the option to lower prices. The Nigerian household loses the option to consumer goods not dominated by foreign brands, which is to say, loses the option to domestic industry. The Nigerian transaction loses the option to a financial system not dominated by foreign banks, which is to say, loses the option to domestic capital

formation.

The witness is the Nigerian who consumes the foreign product and does not question the extraction. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the Nigerian distributor of the foreign product, who profits from the distribution without personally commanding the market access.

3.10 Extraction Triad: Data and Attention

The extractor is the foreign platform that extracts Nigerian users' data and attention. Google, Meta, Twitter/X, TikTok — the Silicon Valley platforms that have become the default infrastructure for Nigerian communication, commerce, and culture. The extraction is performed by the user's engagement with the platform — the search, the post, the like, the scroll.

The subject conforms by using. What is extracted is the data and attention — the user's personal information, behavioural patterns, and cognitive resource. The extraction is invisible to the user because the platform appears as free. The user does not see that they are the product.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Nigerian user loses the option to communicate on a platform that does not extract their data, which is to say, loses the option to digital privacy. The Nigerian user loses the option to a public sphere not mediated by foreign platforms, which is to say, loses the option to democratic discourse not shaped by foreign algorithms. The Nigerian user loses the option to attention not constantly extracted, which is to say, loses the option to a mind not fragmented by the scroll.

The witness is the Nigerian who uses the platform and does not question the extraction. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the Nigerian advertiser who reaches Nigerian consumers through the foreign platform, benefiting from the data extraction without personally commanding it.

Nascent forms of this system include: 'This is how they do it abroad', 'The IMF said', 'The World Bank requires', 'The Americans want', 'The Chinese are building', 'The Saudis are funding', 'FDI is good for the economy', 'We must attract foreign investment', 'We must meet international standards', 'International best practice', 'Global standards', 'The international community expects', 'You must speak English', 'Dress professionally', 'Use the right technology', 'Western education is better', 'Western medicine is better', 'Studies abroad', 'Foreign-trained', 'Returnee', 'Diaspora', 'International exposure', 'Global citizen', 'First-world standards', 'Civilisation', 'Modernisation', 'Development', 'We need foreign aid', 'We need foreign loans', 'We need foreign experts', 'We need foreign technology', 'The dollar is stronger', 'The dollar is the global reserve currency', 'The IMF structural adjustment programme', 'The World Bank poverty reduction strategy', 'The Chinese loan', 'The Chinese contractor', 'The American pastor', 'The American televangelist', 'The Saudi-trained Imam', 'The Silicon Valley startup', 'The tech bro culture', 'The platform economy', 'The social media influencer', 'The foreign NGO', 'The Gates Foundation', 'USAID', 'DFID'.

SECTION 3 · NAIVE APPROACH

3. The Disciplinary Domain

When the ten triads above link into networks, Invasion scales. The link can be hierarchical (the enforcer at one level is the subject at the level above) or community-based (the witness at one triad becomes the enforcer at another). Both forms are visible in every Nigerian institution that interfaces with foreign power.

4.1 Disciplinary Hierarchy — Nested Stars

A Disciplinary Hierarchy is a chain of nested triads. The enforcer at one level is the subject at the level above. Each middle position is simultaneously subject above and enforcer below. Invasion spreads through this form in every Nigerian institution that is penetrated by foreign power.

Peak Triad-Node

At the peak is the triad where the highest foreign authority in the hierarchy enforces on the layer below. The peak enforcer is the foreign institution itself — the IMF Managing Director, the World Bank President, the Chinese Ambassador, the American megachurch senior pastor, the Silicon Valley CEO. The peak extracts natural resources, labour, capital, market access, data, and regulatory concessions from the layer below.

In the IMF/World Bank hierarchy, the peak is the IMF Managing Director enforcing on the Africa Department, which enforces on the Nigeria Mission, which enforces on the Nigerian Federal Ministry of Finance, which enforces on the CBN Governor, which enforces on the commercial bank MD, which enforces on the customer. In the Chinese construction hierarchy, the peak is the Chinese Ambassador enforcing on the Chinese contractor MD, which enforces on the Chinese project manager, which enforces on the Nigerian sub-contractor, which enforces on the Nigerian casual worker.

Middle Triad-Nodes

The middle nodes are where the chain's character is clearest. Each middle enforcer is simultaneously subject above and enforcer below. The Nigerian Permanent Secretary who kneels for the IMF country representative in the morning demands kneeling from the Director in the afternoon. The Nigerian senior pastor who defers to the American senior pastor at the conference demands deference from the Nigerian parish pastor at the meeting.

The middle is where Invasion reproduces. The Nigerian subject of today is the enforcer of tomorrow — as a foreign-trained economist, a foreign-trained pastor, a foreign-trained manager. The middle position teaches the subject to want the position above, which means learning to enforce on those below. By the time the Nigerian becomes a senior official, they have been disciplined by Invasion for decades.

Bottom Triad-Node

At the bottom is the triad where the lowest-ranked foreign-aligned enforcer enforces on the most vulnerable Nigerian. The Nigerian bank officer enforcing on the Nigerian customer. The Nigerian sub-contractor enforcing on the Nigerian casual worker. The Nigerian parish pastor enforcing on the Nigerian member. The Nigerian content moderator enforcing on the Nigerian user. The Nigerian NGO field officer enforcing on the Nigerian community volunteer. The bottom is where the system's violence is most concentrated.

The bottom node is also where the hierarchy meets the community form. The Nigerian bank officer who is enforced on by the IMF-aligned CBN is simultaneously the enforcer in the church, where they enforce the foreign-imported theology on the Nigerian member. The intersection of hierarchy and community is what makes Invasion inescapable — the Nigerian subject is enforced on at work by the foreign economic hierarchy and enforces at church the foreign religious hierarchy.

4.2 Disciplinary Community — Distributed Network

A Disciplinary Community is a distributed network. There is no peak, no chain of command. There is only circulation. The witness of one Invasion triad becomes the enforcer, subject, or witness of another. Invasion spreads laterally through any person who has witnessed foreign enforcement without dissenting.

The Foreign-Trained Alumni Network

The foreign-trained alumni network is the textbook Invasion community. The London School of Economics, Harvard, MIT, Oxford, Cambridge alumni who return to Nigeria circulate the foreign economic, technological, and cultural standards across the Nigerian professional class. The alumni who attended the American university return with the American framing of 'best practice.' The alumni who attended the British university return with the British framing of 'professionalism.'

The Diaspora Network

The diaspora network circulates Invasion laterally across the Nigerian family. The cousin in London sends the Western clothes. The sibling in America sends the iPhones. The uncle in Dubai sends the foreign currency. The diaspora network reproduces the foreign standard across the Nigerian household, with no central command issuing the demand. The pattern circulates by repeated witnessing.

The Foreign Religion Fellowships

The foreign religion fellowships circulate the foreign theology laterally. The Nigerian Pentecostal who attends the American conference returns with the American prosperity gospel. The Nigerian Muslim who attends the Saudi-funded training returns with the Wahhabist theology. The fellowships reproduce the foreign theology across the Nigerian religious community, with no central command issuing the demand.

The Social Media Influencer Networks

The social media influencer networks circulate the Silicon Valley platform economy laterally. The Nigerian influencer on Instagram, TikTok, and Twitter/X reproduces the foreign platform's attention economy, the foreign platform's aesthetic standards, and the foreign platform's monetisation model. The influencer who has 100,000 followers is the agent of the foreign platform's invasion, whether they know it or not.

The 'International Best Practice' Consultant Community

The 'international best practice' consultant community circulates the foreign economic management standard laterally. The Nigerian consultant who works for McKinsey, BCG, Bain, Deloitte, PwC, KPMG, EY reproduces the foreign consulting firm's framing of Nigerian problems and solutions. The consultant who has worked for the foreign firm returns to the Nigerian government with the foreign framing. The pattern circulates without any central command.

The Foreign NGO Worker Community

The foreign NGO worker community circulates the foreign welfare model laterally. The Nigerian who works for USAID, DFID, the Gates Foundation, the Ford Foundation, the Open Society Foundation reproduces the foreign foundation's framing of Nigerian problems and solutions. The NGO worker who has worked for the foreign foundation returns to the Nigerian civil service with the foreign framing. The pattern circulates.

The Foreign Corporate Worker Community

The foreign corporate worker community circulates the foreign corporate culture laterally. The Nigerian who works for MTN, Shell, Unilever, Standard Chartered, Google reproduces the foreign corporation's culture, dress, language, and standards. The corporate worker who has worked for the foreign corporation returns to the Nigerian company with the foreign corporate culture. The pattern circulates.

SECTION 4 · NAIVE APPROACH

4. The Structural Domain

Run the Ship of Theseus test. When the people in the initial Invasion triads are dead and replaced, when the networks are disbanded and reform, what is consistent? What outlives both individuals and groups? What forces new individuals and groups to re-form into the same patterns — not because anyone instructs them to, but because the residue makes any other pattern costly or invisible?

Invasion leaves all three residues. It is one of the most total systems in the framework. Almost every Nigerian institution carries Bureaucracy, Stratification, and Classification from Invasion simultaneously.

5.1 Bureaucracy — Enduring Rules and Procedures

Invasion's bureaucracy is the codified foreign-standard structure. The Bretton Woods institutions — the IMF and World Bank — are the central bureaucracy of the neoliberalism instance. The Paris Club of sovereign creditors codifies the foreign-debt bureaucracy. The African Development Bank, though Africa-based, operates on the same model. The Debt Management Office (DMO), established in 2000, codifies Nigerian external debt management on the foreign model.

The CBN's IMF-aligned monetary policy framework codifies the foreign standard of monetary management. The Investment and Securities Act codifies the foreign standard of capital markets. The NCC (Nigerian Communications Commission) codifies the foreign-influenced telecoms regulation. The NUPRC (Nigerian Upstream Petroleum Regulatory Commission) codifies the foreign-influenced oil regulation. The NEPZA (Nigeria Export Processing Zones Authority) codifies the foreign-owned free trade zones.

The OIC (Organisation of Islamic Cooperation) membership of 1986 codified Nigeria's formal alignment with the Islamic world, opening the door to Saudi-funded Islamic institutions. The Saudi-funded Islamic institutions — the universities, the mosques, the scholarships — codify the Wahhabist bureaucracy. The American evangelical church networks' legal registration codifies the American-religion bureaucracy. The Chinese loan agreements, with their confidentiality clauses, codify the Chinese-economic-invasion bureaucracy.

The AGOA (African Growth and Opportunity Act) trade preference codifies the American trade-standard bureaucracy. The EPA (Economic Partnership Agreement) with the EU codifies the European trade-standard bureaucracy. The original Bretton Woods authors are dead or retired. The bureaucracy lives.

5.2 Stratification — Enduring Zero-Sum Rankings

Invasion's stratification is the daily experience of foreign-power rank in every institutional encounter.

Foreign-trained/local-trained — the foreign-trained Nigerian ranks above the locally-trained in hiring, in promotion, in social standing. **English-speaking/non-English-speaking** — the English-speaking Nigerian ranks above the non-English-speaking in professional life.

Dollar-denominated/naira-denominated — the dollar-denominated salary ranks above the naira-denominated in the multinational corporation. **Foreign-citizen/Nigerian-citizen** — the foreign citizen working in Nigeria ranks above the Nigerian citizen in the foreign corporation's compensation structure. **Returnee/non-returnee** — the returnee ranks above the non-returnee in the Nigerian professional hierarchy.

Foreign-company/local-company — the foreign company ranks above the local company in market standing and consumer trust. **International/local NGO** — the international NGO ranks above the local NGO in funding access and policy influence. **Foreign-standard/local-standard** — the foreign-standard ranks above the local-standard in every domain of professional life. The ranking is in the air; it does not need to be announced.

The Lagos multinational office enforces stratification without anyone issuing an order. The expatriate CEO has the corner office with the air conditioning. The foreign-trained Nigerian Director has the office with the window. The locally-trained Manager has the cubicle. The Officer has the open plan. The Intern has the standing desk. The NYSC Corps Member has the floor. The seating is the rank. Challenging the seating is challenging the foreign-power order.

5.3 Classification — Enduring Categorical Divisions

Invasion's classification is the set of categorical names that organise every Nigerian into foreign-power categories. **Foreign** and **local** — the universal pair, with foreign as the legitimate and local as the deficient. **International** and **domestic** — the same pair in different language, with international as the aspiration and domestic as the constraint.

Western and **indigenous** — the cultural pair, with Western as the modern and indigenous as the traditional. **Modern** and **traditional** — the temporal pair, with modern as the future and traditional as the past. **Developed** and **developing** — the economic pair, with developed as the goal and developing as the deficiency.

First-world and **third-world** — the Cold War pair, with first-world as the aspiration and third-world as the failure. **Global** and **local** — the scale pair, with global as the legitimate and local as the parochial. **English-speaking** and **non-English-speaking** — the language pair, with English-speaking as the professional and non-English-speaking as the unprofessional.

Dollar and **naira** — the currency pair, with dollar as the stable and naira as the volatile.

Foreign-trained and **local-trained** — the credential pair, with foreign-trained as the qualified and local-trained as the suspect. **Returnee** and **native** — the migration pair, with returnee as the cosmopolitan and native as the provincial. **Diaspora** and **home** — the location pair, with diaspora as the success and home as the failure. The classification does the work before any individual enforcer

shows up.

SECTION 5

5. The Hegemonic Domain: The Ascension Ritual

Is Invasion ascended? Yes on all three counts. It produces all three structural residues including Stratification (so Internalised Domination applies). It has working Canon and Practice mechanisms. The vast majority of Nigerians cannot imagine a society without IMF/World Bank policy conditions, without dollar dependence, without Saudi-funded Islam, without American evangelical Christianity, without Silicon Valley platforms, without Chinese infrastructure loans — despite the fact that all six are recent impositions within living memory.

6.1 Canon — Rewriting History

Canon is the present belief that the foreign-standard structure has always been so. The origination of the structural residues — the Bretton Woods institutions, the Saudi-funded Islamic institutions, the American evangelical networks, the Silicon Valley platforms, the Chinese loan era — has been forgotten. The average Nigerian now takes the foreign-standard structure as natural, eternal, and without alternative.

What is forgotten? That the naira was once at parity with the dollar at independence in 1960. The naira was stronger than the dollar in the early 1980s. The collapse of the naira is a 1986 SAP aftermath, not a natural feature of the currency. The dollar dependence is a recent imposition, not an eternal condition.

Also forgotten: that the IMF SAP of 1986 was imposed under military rule without public consent. The Babangida regime adopted the SAP as a condition of IMF loan negotiations, against the expressed opposition of the Nigerian public in the 1985 debate. The SAP has been the framework of Nigerian economic policy for four decades, but it was never consented to.

Also forgotten: that the foreign oil majors have been extracting Niger Delta oil since the 1950s with the vast majority of profit leaving the country. Shell discovered oil in Oloibiri in 1956. The concession structure has always favoured the foreign major. The Niger Delta's poverty in the midst of its wealth is the direct result of foreign extraction. That the Pentecostal prosperity gospel was imported from American televangelism in the 1970s and 1980s. That the Saudi-funded Wahhabist Islam was imported from the 1970s onward, displacing the more tolerant Sufi Islam (Tijaniyya, Qadiriyya) that had been dominant in northern Nigeria.

Also forgotten: that the Silicon Valley platform economy was imported in the 2010s and now structures Nigerian commerce, communication, and culture. That the Chinese infrastructure loan era began in the 2000s under the Obasanjo administration, with the railway modernisation, the airport rehabilitation, the port expansion. That each of these was a political decision, not a natural

development. The Canon presents them as the natural order of modern life. The history shows them as recent impositions that the Nigerian public has not consented to in any meaningful sense.

Internalised Domination

Canon produces Internalised Domination because Invasion produces Stratification. The foreign expert's entitlement to advise Nigerian policy is now natural, automatic, unquestionable. The IMF country representative who demands fuel subsidy removal does not experience this as a demand. They experience it as the natural order of economic management.

The foreign investor's entitlement to profit repatriation is natural. The foreign-trained Nigerian's entitlement to senior positions is natural. The dollar's entitlement to reserve currency status is natural. The foreign religion's entitlement to truth is natural. The foreign technology's entitlement to default is natural. Each entitlement grows with repetition. The first time the IMF demanded fuel subsidy removal, the Nigerian government felt surprise. The hundredth time, the Nigerian government feels resignation. The entitlement has been internalised so deeply that its non-fulfilment registers as the Nigerian government's failure.

Internalised Authority

Canon produces Internalised Authority in the foreign-aligned enforcer regardless of personal material gain. The IMF official who demands policy changes gains nothing material from each individual change. The foreign consultant who prescribes gains nothing material from each individual prescription. The American pastor who plants churches gains nothing material from each individual plant. The Saudi-trained Sheikh who defines true Islam gains nothing material from each individual definition. The Silicon Valley CEO who sets platform rules gains nothing material from each individual rule.

The Nigerian official who enforces the foreign standard on the Nigerian subject gains nothing material. The Nigerian central bank official who enforces the IMF monetary framework gains nothing material. The Nigerian religious leader who enforces the foreign theology gains nothing material. The Nigerian content moderator who enforces the platform rules gains nothing material. The right to enforce feels natural, automatic, and legitimate. That is the Internalised Authority.

Internalised Oppression

Canon produces Internalised Oppression in the Nigerian policymaker, the Nigerian worker, the Nigerian religious practitioner, the Nigerian user. The Nigerian policymaker is taught that they cannot refuse IMF advice. The Nigerian worker is taught that they cannot refuse foreign management. The Nigerian religious practitioner is taught that they cannot refuse foreign religion. The Nigerian user is taught that they cannot refuse foreign platform terms. The teaching is silent; it is in the air.

The Nigerian Finance Minister who is told by a foreign consultant 'this is international best practice' is being disciplined by Canon. The Nigerian Imam who is told by the Saudi-trained Sheikh 'this is the true Islam' is being disciplined by Canon. The Nigerian pastor who is told by the American televangelist 'this is the biblical model' is being disciplined by Canon. The Nigerian user who is told by

the platform ‘you must accept the terms to continue’ is being disciplined by Canon. Each internalises the impossibility of refusal.

The deepest form of this is the Nigerian who has absorbed Invasion so thoroughly that they enforce it on themselves. The Nigerian economist who says ‘we must attract foreign investment’ to explain why they support the race-to-the-bottom in regulation. The Nigerian Muslim who says ‘the Saudi interpretation is the true Islam’ to explain why they reject the Sufi tradition of their grandparents. The Nigerian Christian who says ‘the American model is the biblical model’ to explain why they reject the mainline tradition of their grandparents. The Nigerian user who says ‘I must be on the platform’ to explain why they cannot leave. The rebellion-capable subject has become the self-policing subject.

6.2 Practice — Rewriting Reality

Practice is the second mechanism of the Ascension Ritual. The interpersonal triad is repeated, again and again, until it becomes habit. The foreign-aligned enforcer forgets they can choose not to enforce. The Nigerian subject forgets they can rebel. The witness forgets they can dissent. The middle-aged Nigerian professional who has been both subject and enforcer forgets they were ever either.

Pierre Bourdieu called this *habitus* — the sediment of repeated practice in the body. Anibal Quijano, in his work on the colonality of power, showed how the colonial relation persists in the body of the post-colonial subject: the Latin American (or African) who reflexively defers to the European (or American) frame, who reflexively cites the foreign source, who reflexively adopts the foreign standard. The body learns. The mind stops questioning.

By the time the Nigerian child is twelve, the foreign standard is reflex. They know English is the language of school. They know the Western suit is the dress of professional life. They know the foreign platform is the infrastructure of communication. They know the foreign religion is the truth. By adulthood, the Nigerian has performed the foreign-standard, foreign-religion, foreign-technology, foreign-culture, and foreign-law triads so many thousands of times that the alternative — refusing the foreign, returning to the indigenous — feels like a kind of amputation. The body has been trained. Practice has rewritten reality.

Death — Fast and Slow

Practice produces Death. Fast death in Invasion is spectacular: the Boko Haram insurgency, fueled by Saudi-imported Wahhabist theology, has killed over 350,000 people since 2009 and displaced over 2.5 million. The Niger Delta militancy, fueled by foreign oil extraction, killed thousands in the 2004-2009 intensification and continues in episodic form. The mob violence enabled by foreign social media disinformation — the 2017 false rumours on Facebook that triggered ethnic killings in Plateau State.

The foreign-contractor workplace deaths on Chinese-built construction sites — the worker killed by the crane, the worker killed in the trench, the worker killed in the explosion. The foreign-religion-mob killings — the Deborah Samuel lynching in Sokoto in May 2022, the Bridget Agbahome killing in Kano in June 2016, both enabled by the Wahhabist displacement of more tolerant northern Islam. The death of the local business crushed by foreign competition — the textile factories that closed in

Kaduna and Kano in the 1990s because they could not compete with Asian imports.

The death of the local farmer whose land was seized for foreign agribusiness — the Zamfara farmer displaced by the foreign-owned gold mine, the Benue farmer displaced by the foreign-owned plantation. Each is a death attributable to Invasion's extraction triad. The Niger Delta community member killed by the gas flare, by the oil spill, by the military repression that protects the foreign oil major.

Slow death in Invasion is quiet. Chronic stress from constant dollar-naira anxiety — the Nigerian who has not slept properly in years because the next devaluation is always approaching. Mental health collapse from the coloniality of knowledge — the Nigerian academic who has internalised the foreign citation as the only legitimate citation, and whose body breaks down under the cognitive dissonance of working in a Nigerian university on foreign terms.

The slow death of indigenous languages — Yoruba, Igbo, Hausa, and hundreds of others — as English displaces them in education, business, and family life. The slow death of indigenous religions as foreign Christianity and foreign Islam marginalise them. The slow death of indigenous medicine as Western medicine displaces it. The slow death of indigenous agriculture as foreign agribusiness displaces it. The slow death of indigenous food systems as foreign processed food displaces them.

The slow death of the local economy from capital flight — the \$15-18 billion a year that leaves Nigeria as illicit financial flows. The slow death of fiscal sovereignty as the IMF/World Bank framework constrains Nigerian policy. The slow death of monetary sovereignty as the dollar dependence constrains the naira. The slow death of the naira from dollar dependence — from parity at independence to over 1,500 naira per dollar in 2024. The slow death of cultural confidence — the Nigerian who reflexively defers to the foreign frame, who reflexively cites the foreign source, who reflexively adopts the foreign standard. None of these make the news. They are Invasion's quiet tax.

Ruth Wilson Gilmore's definition applies: Invasion produces group-differentiated vulnerability to premature death. The groups are the Niger Delta communities, the communities displaced by foreign agribusiness, the workers on foreign construction sites, the subjects of foreign-religion violence, the local businesses crushed by foreign competition, the indigenous-language speakers, the indigenous-religion practitioners, the naira-dependent Nigerians. The premature death is fast (insurgency, militancy, mob violence, workplace death, displacement death) or slow (dollar anxiety, cognitive dissonance, language death, religion death, medicine death, agriculture death, capital flight, fiscal sovereignty death, monetary sovereignty death, cultural confidence death). Every ascended matrix kills. Invasion kills those whose relation to the foreign does not fit the extraction-and-enforcement model.

SECTION 6

6. When Did Invasion Rewrite History?

The framework's historical question: when did Invasion rewrite history in popular Nigerian living memory, such that the average Nigerian cannot recall a time when its structural residue was not present? This is not a history of how Invasion was built. It is a diagnosis of when the building was forgotten.

Pre-invasion Nigeria was not free of foreign power — the colonial invasion had been present since the 1860s and formal colonisation since 1900. But the specific forms of Invasion covered in this chapter have different timelines. The naira was at parity with the dollar at independence in 1960. The Nigerian government had policy autonomy in the 1960s and 1970s, even under military rule. The Sufi Islam of the Tijaniyya and Qadiriyya was dominant in the North. The mainline Christianity of the Anglican, Methodist, Baptist, and Catholic churches was dominant in the South.

The neoliberalism instance intensified with the SAP of 1986, imposed under the Babangida regime. The SAP marked the formal subordination of Nigerian economic policy to IMF/World Bank conditionality. The religious invasions intensified in the 1970s: the Saudi-funded Wahhabist Islam, fuelled by the oil boom that gave Saudi Arabia the resources to export its theology; the American evangelical Christianity, fuelled by the same oil boom that gave American televangelists the resources to broadcast globally.

The Silicon Valley tech invasion intensified in the 2010s, with the spread of smartphones and the launch of Nigerian operations by Google, Meta, and other platforms. The Chinese economic invasion intensified in the 2000s, with the Obasanjo-era infrastructure loans and the expansion of Chinese construction companies. The dollar hegemony intensified with the SAP, as the naira was devalued and the dollar became the implicit reference currency for Nigerian economic life.

The tipping point in popular living memory: **circa 1986 for the IMF SAP; circa 1970s for the religious invasions; circa 2000s for the Chinese and Silicon Valley invasions.** For Nigerians born after 1960 — the post-independence generation — Invasion has 'always been' in its current form. They cannot recall a time when the IMF was not the framework of economic policy, when the naira was not collapsing, when the Saudi-funded mosque was not the model of Islamic authority, when the American megachurch was not the model of Christian worship, when the Silicon Valley platform was not the infrastructure of communication.

The pre-invasion generation (born ~1930s-1940s) was the last to have living memory of the naira at parity with the dollar, of pre-Wahhabist northern Islam, of pre-Pentecostal southern Christianity. By the 1990s, the SAP-induced economic invasion had become the natural order. By the 2010s, the Silicon Valley tech invasion had become the natural order. The question 'is IMF conditionality natural?' had stopped being asked in popular memory by the 1990s. The question 'is dollar dependence natural?' stopped being asked by the 2000s. The question 'is Silicon Valley platform dominance

natural?’ stopped being asked by the 2010s.

SECTION 7

7. Fill in the Blank: A Self-Examination

The framework asks two questions of every subject of every ascended matrix. The blanks are for you. They are not rhetorical. The point of the framework is not to understand Invasion in the abstract. It is to locate yourself inside it, so that the next time the triad assembles around you — or around someone whose relation to the foreign does not fit the extraction-and-enforcement model — you can see it.

Question 1: When did Invasion rewrite your reality?

When did the system teach you that you could not rebel? The moment was: _____. The year was: _____. The foreign institution or foreign-aligned person who first made you feel that challenging the foreign standard was impossible was: _____. The place was: _____. What you wanted to say but did not was: _____. What you did instead was: _____. What you told yourself about why you did not say it was: _____. The foreign standard you assumed in that moment was: _____. The form of address you used was: _____. What you lost, in that moment, that you have not got back since, was: _____. The instance of Invasion at the centre of the moment (IMF/World Bank, dollar, Saudi, American evangelical, Silicon Valley, Chinese) was: _____.

Question 2: How is Invasion causing your Death?

How is the system shortening your life right now? The form of Death I am most afraid of from Invasion is (fast/slow): _____. The specific way it is happening in my body is: _____. (For example: the chronic stress from years of dollar-naira anxiety; the insomnia from years of swallowing the devaluation; the loss of self from years of being told the foreign is better; the breakdown I had in 20__ that I have never fully recovered from; the indigenous language I no longer speak because English displaced it; the indigenous religion I cannot practice because the foreign religion is the default; the indigenous medicine I cannot access because Western medicine is the only legitimate form; the naira that loses value every month; the platform I cannot leave because everyone I know is on it; the foreign expert I cannot challenge because I am told they know better.) The matrix’s name for what is happening to me is: _____. My own name for it is: _____.

If you filled in the blanks honestly, you have just located yourself inside Invasion. The next time the triad assembles — the next time the IMF demands, the next time the platform terms are updated, the next time the foreign-trained consultant prescribes, the next time the dollar-naira rate moves — you will be able to see the system moving through you. That sight is the beginning of abolition. And if you

are now the enforcer in the triad — the foreign-trained official, the foreign-aligned religious leader, the foreign-corporate manager — the sight is also the beginning of your refusal to enforce.

SECTION 8

8. Endnotes & References

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Coming Next

Chapter 10 will take up Settler Colonialism — the system by which foreigners invade a locale to extract existence from the locals and enforce their own existence at the expense of the locals. The framework’s outline notes that there is no actual case of adult settler colonialism in Nigeria, though nascent and fledgling forms exist. Settler Colonialism is studied in other countries (Israel-Palestine, the United States, Australia, Canada, South Africa) as a warning of just how bad a system like this can get if it is allowed to grow to adulthood and ascend. The framework separates Settler Colonialism from Invasion (Chapter 9, which extracts resources) and from Coloniality (Chapter 11, which is the residue of concluded invasions).

If you are reading this chapter as part of the framework in progress, the order continues: Chapter 11 is Coloniality, Chapter 12 is Somatic Normativity, Chapter 13 is Retributivism, and so on through the Fundamental Matrices. Each chapter follows the same template established in Chapters 2 through 9. The naive approach in the first three domains. The Ascension Ritual in the fourth. The historical memory trace. The fill-in-the-blank. The endnotes. The pattern is now set.